14.4.3 Publishing using Visual Studio

The `publish` command within Visual Studio is available from the Build menu. You can also access it by right-clicking the web application project in Solution Explorer, where it will appear in the resulting context menu. Either way, you will be presented with the same interface for managing the publishing process. The first time you use this feature for your project, you will be prompted to create a *publish profile*. You begin this process by specifying your publishing target, or where you would like to publish to. The preconfigured options include a Docker container, an FTP server, to an IIS server using Web Deploy, or to a local folder. You are also provided with the option to import an external *publish settings* profile, which is what the publish wizard creates.

Once you have selected your publishing target, the wizard prompts you to configure the publish profile accordingly. For example, if you choose to publish to an FTP server, the wizard asks for the server address, the file path on the remote server for the deployed application, and any credentials required by the FTP server. We will look at publishing to a local folder in more detail here, so you can examine the published output.

TIP Most of the other publishing options are supported by documentation (http://mng.bz/K0RX).

You'll start by selecting the Folder option and then either noting the default location (bin\Release\net6.0\publish) or changing it to one that is more accessible. Next click the Finish button. Note that the default configuration is `Release` (compared to `Debug` when using the CLI). You have the option to delete all existing files each time the application is published to ensure only the latest versions are deployed. You can also configure the target runtime, which, by default, is set to Portable, which enables the application to be deployed to any platform where a runtime is installed.